

CONTEXT & SOURCES

Digital Intake Adoption Improvement

CANADIAN DIGITAL HEALTH LANDSCAPE

Canada's health care system has made great progress in the adoption of digital health systems, but availability does not always translate into consistent or effective use. Statistics Canada's 2025 Survey on the Use of Digital Technologies by Health Care Providers found that 92% of Canadian health care providers had access to a digital health system, and 52% reported using a digital health system to share patient clinical information electronically outside their practice setting.

The survey also found that 78% of providers experienced at least one barrier that limited them from sharing patient clinical information through digital health systems. These findings provide a current Canadian basis for examining not only if digital tools are available, but also how effectively that support day-to-day information sharing and workflow.

Recent reporting from Canadian Institute for Health Information (CIHI), published in July 2026, provides additional evidence that practical barriers to digital health use remain. CIHI identifies issues including system integration, access processes and the fit of digital tools within everyday clinical workflows.

DIGITAL HEALTH ADOPTION AND USE

Canada Health Infoway's 2024 Canadian Digital Health Survey similarly examines digital health uptake, access to electronic personal health information, connected health and coordination of care, and factors influencing access and utilization. The survey provides broader context on how Canadians experience and use digital health services.

Access to digital systems is widespread, but reported barriers include lack of integration, time-consuming access processes and difficulties incorporating digital instruments into existing workflows. Staff experience friction when a digital workflow involves extra steps, more navigation, or doesn't sync up well with other responsibilities. Patients may also need help where digital processes pose usability or access challenges. The categories of factors to be assessed are set using the external evidence. The specific baseline findings and pilot results presented elsewhere in the portfolio are illustrative project data.

Evidence Area	Evidence	Relevance
Access vs use	92% of Canadian health care providers had access to a digital health system, while 52% reported using digital systems to share patient clinical information outside their main practice setting. [1]	Supports distinguishing technology availability from consistent operational use.
System integration	Insufficient integration was the most frequently reported barrier in Statistics Canada's 2025 survey, reported by 50% of providers in scope.	Supports examining workflow and system-related friction.
Usability friction	Time-consuming or multiple sign-ins were reported by 22% of providers, while 18% identified non-user-friendly systems as a barrier. [1]	Provides evidence for assessing integration and workflow-related friction.
Training and support	14% identified insufficient training and 10% identified insufficient IT support as barriers. [1]	Supports considering staff guidance, training and operational support when assessing adoption.
Workflow fit	CIHI's reporting identifies insufficient integration, time-consuming or multiple sign-ins, permissions and workflow usability among practical barriers affecting digital health use.	Reinforces the assessment of workflow fit and operational usability using more recent Canadian evidence.

EVIDENCE LIMITATIONS

Sources in this document mention use of digital health and barriers in Canadian healthcare settings. They do not specify the reasons for low adoption in the simulated clinic. Accordingly, external evidence and factors to be considered are identified that inform the assessment framework, while the baseline data at the clinic level, pilot results and results presented in the portfolio are illustrative.

REFERENCES

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- [2] Canada Health Infoway. "Canadians Embrace Digital Health and Demand Greater Access to Health Information: 2024 Canadian Digital Health Survey Results Released." May 2025. <https://nationtalk.ca/story/canadians-embrace-digital-health-and-demand-greater-access-to-health-information-2024-canadian-digital-health-survey-results-released>
- [3] Canadian Institute for Health Information (CIHI). *Digital health information in Canada: Measuring access and use*. Published July 23, 2026. <https://www.cihi.ca/en/digital-health-information-in-canada-measuring-access-and-use>
- [4] Digital Health Canada. "Beyond Pilots: Why Some Digital Health Interventions Fail to Scale." October 2024. <https://digitalhealthcanada.com/beyond-pilots-why-some-digital-health-interventions-fail-to-scale/>
- [5] Canadian Medical Association, Canada Health Infoway, College of Family Physicians of Canada, & Royal College of Physicians and Surgeons of Canada. "Digital Health Interoperability Task Force Report." November 2024. <https://www.infoway-inforoute.ca/en/component/edocman/6498-digital-health-interoperability-task-force-report/view-document?Itemid=103>
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- [7] Protti, D. et al. "A Qualitative Study of Canada's Experience with the Implementation of Electronic Health Information Technology." PMC. <https://ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3060213/?tool=pubmed>
- [8] Canada Health Infoway & Canadian Medical Association. "2024 National Survey of Canadian Physicians" (conducted by Leger, 1,145 respondents). September 2024. <https://www.cma.ca/about-us/what-we-do/press-room/canada-health-infoway-canadian-medical-association-survey-shows-physicians-are-embracing-connected>